CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poem is a mock-heroic ballad because it: 1

(a) is about a real battle
(b) is a hymn
(c) treats a comic event in the style of a heroic tale
(d) is a lament

2. The poet's attitude to Custard is: 1

(a) hostile **(b)** affectionate **(c)** indifferent **(d)** scornful

3. In 'The dragon who was timid saved them', 'who was timid' is: 1

(a) an adverb clause **(b)** a relative clause
(c) a main clause **(d)** a noun clause

4. The best summary of the poem's attitude to heroes is: 1

(a) they must be rich **(b)** they may be the ones we least expect
(c) they must be strong **(d)** they must be loud

5. The structure of the poem follows: 1

(a) a list
(b) introduction of characters, conflict, climax and ironic resolution
(c) a letter
(d) a debate

6. A possible allegorical reading is that Custard represents: 1

(a) a bully **(b)** a miser
(c) a ruler **(d)** the quiet person who acts when needed

7. A synonym for 'bravado' is: 1

(a) calm **(b)** false show of courage
(c) fear **(d)** true courage

8. The irony of the final stanza is: 1

(a) the pirate returns **(b)** Belinda leaves
(c) the dog wins **(d)** the hero is named a coward still

9. The poem's tone can be described as: 1

(a) angry **(b)** bitter
(c) playful and affectionately mocking **(d)** solemn

10. The poem would be less effective without: 1

(a) the contrast between looks and character **(b)** a title
(c) the rhyme only **(d)** the pirate's name

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Explain how the poem uses the mock-heroic mode. 2

12. Why is Custard's unchanged timidity important? 2

13. How does the narrator's tone influence the reader's response? 2

14. Why is the repetition of the opening comparisons at the end effective? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically comment on the poem's use of irony. 3

16. Evaluate the moral of the poem for modern readers. 3

17. Convert into direct speech: Belinda told them that the pirate had come. 3

OR

Evaluate the poem as a work of nonsense verse. 3

18. Explain how the poem could be staged as a puppet show. 3

OR

Use 'not only...but also', 'however' and 'unless' in sentences about the poem. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'The Tale of Custard the Dragon' is a comic poem with a serious point. Discuss. 5

OR

Discuss the poem as an example of mock-heroic literature. 5

20. Critically analyse the techniques used by Ogden Nash to create humour. 5

OR

Write a letter from Belinda to a friend explaining how Custard saved her. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND